



THE PACIFIC ISLANDS AND AUSTRALIA COVER AN AREA larger

THE PACIFIC^{AND} AUSTRALIA

than Asia but
the landmass

is smaller than

Europe's. At over

A CONTINENT OF THOUSANDS OF ISLANDS

PACIFIC AND AUSTRALIA FACTS

PLACES

Highest pointMt. Wilhelm, Papua New Guinea,
14,793 ft (4,509 m)

Biggest desertGreat Australian Desert, Australia

Longest riverMurray-Darling, Australia,
2,330 miles (3,750 km)

Biggest countryAustralia

PEOPLE

Population of continent30 million

Most densely populated countryNauru, 1,469 per
sq mile (567 people per sq km)

Most populous countryAustralia, 19 million

Most populous citySydney, Australia, 4.1 million

LITERACY RATE

Male86 percent

Female71 percent

Micronesia

This area includes the
Marshall Islands, Nauru,
and Palau.



Australia

Two-thirds of
Australia is a
great plateau of
deserts and
mountains.

New Zealand

The country comprises
two islands—the
North Island and the
South Island.

The Pacific Islands

Many of the islands in the Pacific became European colonies in the 19th century. Some are still colonies or are administered under international agreements, but most have recently grouped together to form small independent nations.

